



# LOST BOYS CYBER

THREAT INTELLIGENCE • MALWARE ANALYSIS • DETECTION ENGINEERING



## AI Automation and Incident Response Threat Trends

### Threat Report

|                       |                 |
|-----------------------|-----------------|
| <b>Classification</b> | TLP:CLEAR       |
| <b>Published</b>      | 2026-08-03      |
| <b>Version</b>        | 1.0             |
| <b>Author</b>         | Lost Boys Cyber |
| <b>Report Type</b>    | Threat Report   |

TLP:CLEAR | Lost Boys Cyber | AI Automation and Incident Response Threat Trends - Threat Report

Published: 2026-08-03 | TLP:CLEAR | Version: 1.0 | Author: Lost Boys Cyber

AI Generation: This report was generated with AI assistance and is provided for informational purposes only. All findings, IOCs, detection rules, hunting queries, attribution assessments, and recommendations must be independently reviewed and validated by a qualified security professional before operational use.

## Table of Contents

1. Executive Summary
2. Intelligence Requirements
3. Source Review & Confidence
4. Threat Activity Overview
5. Affected Sectors and Exposure
6. Aviation and Aerospace Sector Impact
7. Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures
8. Infrastructure and Indicators
9. Detection Engineering
  - 9.1. Detection Summary
10. Threat Hunting
  - 10.1. Hunt Hypothesis
11. Risk Assessment
12. Recommended Actions
13. References

# AI Automation and Incident Response Threat Trends

## 1. Executive Summary

Unit 42's July 2026 discussion of AI, automation, and attacks reinforces a defender priority: attackers and defenders are both accelerating operations with AI-enabled workflows. Security teams should evaluate identity, automation, and telemetry controls rather than treating AI as a separate risk silo.

Analyst judgment: the reporting is useful for near-term defensive review because it maps to active exposure areas: identity abuse, edge/infrastructure access, supply-chain dependencies, AI/software pipeline trust, industrial systems, or sector-specific operations. This report is not an attribution declaration; it translates public reporting into defender actions.

## 2. Intelligence Requirements

| Question                             | Current Answer                                                                                        | Confidence |
|--------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| What should defenders review today?  | Review automation identities, model/tool access, logging, and incident-response playbooks.            | Medium     |
| Which environments are most exposed? | Aerospace engineering, airline operations, enterprise SOC's, and defense contractors using automation | Medium     |
| What telemetry is needed?            | Identity, endpoint, proxy, DNS, cloud audit, and vulnerability-management data                        | High       |

## 3. Source Review & Confidence

| Source                              | Contribution               | Confidence |
|-------------------------------------|----------------------------|------------|
| Unit 42: AI, Automation and Attacks | Primary reporting/context  | High       |
| Unit 42 Research Home               | Primary reporting/context  | Medium     |
| NIST AI Risk Management Framework   | AI risk governance context | High       |

## 4. Threat Activity Overview

AI-assisted workflows may amplify phishing, reconnaissance, malware development, and defensive evasion, but many practical controls remain familiar: least privilege, audit logging, anomaly detection, data-governance boundaries, and tested response playbooks.

## 5. Affected Sectors and Exposure

| Sector / Segment        | Exposure Path                                                                                        | Defender Relevance                                             |
|-------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Enterprise IT           | Identity systems, endpoints, edge devices, SaaS                                                      | Common initial-access and lateral-movement path                |
| Critical infrastructure | OT/ICS connectivity, remote access, managed services                                                 | Increased operational impact from service disruption           |
| Aviation / Aerospace    | Airlines, airports, aerospace manufacturing, satellite/space systems, MRO, and aviation supply chain | Validate third-party dependencies and operational segmentation |

## 6. Aviation and Aerospace Sector Impact

| Segment                         | Operational Relevance                                                                                        | Defender Action                                                                                  |
|---------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Airlines and airports           | Reservation, crew, baggage, network, and supplier systems can turn IT compromise into operational disruption | Prioritize identity hardening, service-provider assurance, and incident communications playbooks |
| Aerospace/defense manufacturing | Sensitive engineering data, build pipelines, and suppliers create espionage and supply-chain exposure        | Monitor engineering repositories, contractor access, and privileged tooling                      |
| Satellite/space systems         | Ground-segment, SATCOM, telemetry, and vendor appliances may be shared across customers                      | Validate management-plane isolation and vendor patch status                                      |

## 7. Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures

| Tactic / Phase      | Observed Technique                                                                       | Evidence                                                         |
|---------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Initial Access      | Phishing, valid accounts, exploit public-facing application, or supply-chain trust abuse | Patterns repeatedly highlighted in cited reporting               |
| Discovery           | Network, cloud, repository, or operational process discovery                             | Defenders should monitor enumeration after first access          |
| Collection / Impact | Data theft, service disruption, tooling compromise, or extortion                         | Reported risks affect confidentiality and operational continuity |

## 8. Infrastructure and Indicators

| Indicator / Infrastructure            | Type              | Operational Use                                                    |
|---------------------------------------|-------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| No stable IOC set in public reporting | Source limitation | Focus on behavior, asset exposure, and control validation          |
| Newly created admin sessions          | Behavioral signal | Prioritize identity and audit-log review                           |
| Unexpected build/toolchain activity   | Behavioral signal | Relevant for AI/software supply-chain and engineering environments |

## 9. Detection Engineering

### 9.1. Detection Summary

| Signal                                                      | Telemetry Source              | Analytic Goal                                          |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| First-seen external remote access from uncommon geography   | VPN / IdP / SSO               | Identify identity-led access attempts                  |
| Suspicious scripting or toolchain invocation                | EDR / developer platform logs | Surface execution in build, AI, or engineering systems |
| Unusual outbound connections from operational network zones | Firewall / DNS / proxy        | Detect command-and-control or data staging behavior    |

title: Daily Threat Review Suspicious Toolchain Or Remote Access Activity

```

id: lbc-tr-2026-904-daily-threat-signal
status: experimental
description: Behavior-focused analytic for the 2026-08-03 Lost Boys Cyber daily threat report.
logsource:
  category: process_creation
  product: windows
detection:
  selection_tools:
    Image|endswith:
      - '\powershell.exe'
      - '\pwsh.exe'
      - '\python.exe'
      - '\node.exe'
      - '\git.exe'
  selection_suspicious:
    CommandLine|contains:
      - 'Invoke-WebRequest'
      - 'curl '
      - 'wget '
      - 'token'
      - 'credential'
      - 'pipeline'
  condition: selection_tools and selection_suspicious
falsepositives:
  - Approved automation and engineering activity
level: medium

```

```

DeviceProcessEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where FileName in~ ("powershell.exe", "pwsh.exe", "python.exe", "node.exe", "git.exe")
| where ProcessCommandLine has_any ("Invoke-WebRequest", "curl ", "wget ", "token", "credential",
"pipeline")
| summarize Events=count(), Devices=dcount(DeviceName), Accounts=dcount(InitiatingProcessAccountName)
by FileName, InitiatingProcessAccountName, bin(Timestamp, 1d)
| where Events > 5

```

## 10. Threat Hunting

### 10.1. Hunt Hypothesis

If this activity is present in the environment, analysts should see identity anomalies, unusual tooling in administrative or engineering contexts, and atypical network egress from sensitive systems.

```

DeviceNetworkEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where InitiatingProcessFileName in~ ("powershell.exe", "python.exe", "node.exe", "git.exe",
"java.exe")
| where RemoteUrl !endswith ".microsoft.com" and RemoteUrl !endswith ".windows.net"
| summarize Connections=count(), RemoteHosts=dcount(RemoteUrl) by DeviceName,
InitiatingProcessFileName, bin(Timestamp, 1d)
| where Connections > 20

SigninLogs
| where TimeGenerated > ago(14d)
| where ResultType == 0
| summarize FirstSeen=min(TimeGenerated), Countries=dcount(Location), Apps=dcount(AppDisplayName) by
UserPrincipalName, IPAddress
| where Countries > 1 or Apps > 5

```

## 11. Risk Assessment

| Dimension  | Assessment | Notes                               |
|------------|------------|-------------------------------------|
| Likelihood | Medium     | Based on public reporting and broad |

|            |                |                                                                                                  |
|------------|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|            |                | applicability to common enterprise controls                                                      |
| Impact     | Medium to High | Higher for operationally constrained aviation/aerospace and critical-infrastructure environments |
| Confidence | Medium         | Source depth is public; no private telemetry was available in this run                           |

## 12. Recommended Actions

| Priority | Owner                  | Action                                                                                                 |
|----------|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Critical | SOC                    | Convert the included hunts into environment-specific saved queries and review hits                     |
| High     | Vulnerability / IT Ops | Validate exposed edge, remote access, and managed-service dependencies                                 |
| High     | Aviation / OT Security | Confirm segmentation between business IT, operational aviation systems, engineering, and vendor access |
| Medium   | GRC                    | Add cited reporting to supplier-risk and executive-awareness briefings                                 |

## 13. References

- [1] Unit 42: AI, Automation and Attacks: <https://unit42.paloaltonetworks.com/ai-incident-response-report/>
- [2] Unit 42 Research Home: <https://unit42.paloaltonetworks.com/>
- [3] NIST AI Risk Management Framework: <https://www.nist.gov/itl/ai-risk-management-framework>